Orders

Every order a character can be given: the everyday ones, the alignment signatures and the twenty mastery orders

Kingdoms Call reference sheet. Data file v2026.10.15-1202. Generated 2026-10-19 from the repository (branch at that date). Numbers are what the engine uses today, read straight from its tables; where a figure comes from the rulebook text instead, the section says so.

Each character takes one order per phase, five phases a turn. The orders form offers 46 actions in all: 21 everyday orders, 5 alignment signatures and 20 mastery orders (two for each of the ten non-magic skills; the Sage 9 order is the Grand Design). This sheet lists every one with who can give it, what it needs, what it does, what it costs and what it spends in movement.

What to look for when reviewing

- Is every order worth a phase? Rest, Explore and Practice compete with each other on a quiet turn.
- Which orders are gated by a skill at 1 (Research, Steal, Cast Spell) and which by mastery at 7 or 9.
- The movement costs of conquest (R-081): attack and win costs two points.
- Defend is the longest rule in the game; its summary is here, the worked examples are in the rulebook.

Where this comes from

- Rulebook: Every Order Explained, The Defend order in full, Movement & Marching.
- Player portal: ACTIONS, ACTION_DISPLAY_ORDER, ALIGN_ACTIONS, KING_ONLY_ACTIONS, L79_ORDERS.
- Engine: src/engine/orders/* (one file per family of orders).

Everyday orders and alignment signatures

Order	Group	Who	Needs	Target	What it does	Gold	Movement	Notes
Move	Movement	Any		An adjacent province	Travel one province. Into a defended enemy or neutral province it triggers a battle; with armies you can conquer. A displaced character still heads for the named province.		1 land (1 sea if the step touches water); +1 for a victory	One Move = one province whatever the pool; five phases is the ceiling.
Defend	Movement	Any		none	Keep watch to turn's end over your province and every neighbouring province you own. A general with troops rides out to meet an enemy army marching into, or raised inside, a watched province and fights as the defender (×1.25, ×1.5 at home). A lone character lies in ambush instead (10% + 9%/Spy level, halved against a commander with troops).		1 per ride-out	A blank phase counts as Defend (R-085). One reaction per phase; own gate first; ends on a battle, a Move or an Encounter.
Explore	Scouting	Any		Here	Chart the province: (terrain base) × (Explorer + 1) points. Reveals terrain, wealth, defenders and lairs as the figure climbs.		0	Base per terrain: plains 35, desert 25, sea 25, forest 20, mountain 20, jungle 15.
Search Lair	Scouting	Any	A discovered lair here	A lair	Fight its guardian in personal combat for the hoard: gold, one magic item of the guardian's grade, an HP roll and field experience.		0	Uses the Encounter Plan. A hero who flees leaves the hoard.
Hunting Rumours	Scouting	Any	Known lairs here	Any number of lairs	For each lair paid for, learn the guardian's weakness (kept for that kind forever), the exact hoard, and your own odds in five bands.	Weak 1g, Moderate 2g, Powerful 3g, Legendary 4g	0	Spy fieldwork (may raise Spy). R-035: always learns everything paid for.

Order	Group	Who	Needs	Target	What it does	Gold	Movement	Notes
Spy	Scouting	Any		Here, or a character here	Province: defenders, owner, lairs, characters and their units, and the characters in neighbouring provinces. Character: every skill, item and unit. A rival capital also yields tax income, hero count and a chance to copy a discovery.		0	20% + 20%/level. R-111 lists what spying shows.
Recruit Armies	Armies	Any	A province you hold	Unit types offered here	Raise units at the listed price (paid again as wage the same turn). Garrison units always muster into the garrison. Mercenary bands roaming the province are hired here too.	The unit's cost	0	Cap one of each type per province per turn; two for garrisons, Goblin Hordes, humanoid fleets, and anything at the home capital. Beasts count against the Druid cap.
Hire Hero	Armies	Any	A wandering hero here	A hero	Take them into service at the alignment-distance wage. Their orders for the rest of the turn can be written at once and apply only if the hire lands.	2–4g/turn, plus 1g per 4 skill levels above a fresh hero	0	Higher initiative wins a contested hire. R-014.
Release Hero	Armies	Any (never the king)	Leading no army	Self	Dismiss a hero; they wander again, keeping their items; not re-hirable the same turn.		0	
Disband Army	Armies	Any		Units led	Dismiss units you no longer wish to pay for.		0	
Leave/Transfer Army	Armies	Any		Garrison, or a character here	Drop units as garrison or hand them to another of your characters in the same province.		0	Refused on open water if it would leave either column short of hulls. Beasts count against the receiver's Druid cap.
Pick Up Army	Armies	Any		Garrison units here	Take command of unled units here, all or a subset. Slower units slow the column at once.		0	On open water only what the ships and flyers can carry.
Send Item	Belongings	Any		Any living character of yours	Send one or more magic items anywhere; hand to hand if together, otherwise by courier arriving at turn's end (a Grand Heist can rob a courier).		0	
Equip Items	Belongings	Any		Self	Choose what is worn in every slot: weapon, armour, shield, cloak, helm, two rings, amulet, two combat items. Unslotted items are always active.		0	A character auto-equips the first item held for each slot.
Use Item	Belongings	Any	An item with a Use	Self	Activate a magic item's power; spell items cast their spell at a flat 95% with no skill and no casting slot.		0	Using an item is small Sage experience (R-023).
Encounter Character	Confrontation	Any	A visible enemy character	A character	Hunt them down one province a phase. Once sharing a province, corner them on a Spy contest (70% +5%/your Spy −5%/theirs). Both with armies: a battle; otherwise a duel; a lone hunter must slip through the quarry's camp (60% −8%/unit +5%/Spy −5%/their Tactical, 5–95%).		1 per step	Only a king may run down a king (R-021). Catch chance R-042.
Steal	Confrontation	Any	Thief 1	A character here, or the garrison paymaster	Take one magic item or 5% of the target realm's treasury; a paymaster yields 1g per garrison unit. 50% + 10%/Thief level (to 5), halved against troops or a guarded paymaster. A failed, spotted thief is set upon.		0	Getaway Thief × 20%. Lead with Flee in the Encounter Plan to avoid the fight.
Cast Spell	Power	Any	Level 1 in the school	Per spell	Work an action spell (see the Spells sheet). Cast at 30% + 10%/level, cap 95%. Spells per school per turn 1/1/2/3/3.		0	A spell whose target has ridden out is never worked and costs nothing.
Practice Skill	Self-improvement	Any		A skill (to level 5)	Alone 25/20/15/10/5% for 01 to 45; peers at the same level +50%; a better mentor present makes it automatic. Perseverance ×1.2 per failure this turn. Practising Tactical or Naval also drills the units led.		0	Humans of a Human realm ×1.5.

Order	Group	Who	Needs	Target	What it does	Gold	Movement	Notes
Research	Self-improvement	Any	Sage 1	A field of study	Roll 5% per Sage level (to 5; Neutral double; perseverance ×1.2 per failure this turn). A success brings two discoveries from the field; keep one with your next orders.		0	An unlooked-for find from any field is rolled first, at a long shot.
Rest	Self-improvement	Any		Self	Recover 30% of max HP, rounded up (at least 1); Divine half as much again.		0	
Consecrate	Alignment: Divine	King only	An owned province, not home or its neighbours, not bordering holy ground	A province	Sanctify it: +50% tax, stauncher defenders, Undead and Evil attack at −15%, and the only ground the fallen return on. Up to one per level of the king's White.		0	
Call to Arms	Alignment: Good	King only		Any owned humanoid province	A free Green garrison unit of the native type musters there. Once per turn, from anywhere.		0	
Broker	Alignment: Neutral	King only		A visible wandering hero, or a province ever seen	Hire a distant hero without leaving the hall, or buy a guaranteed full Spy report on a far province.	2g for a report	0	
Perform Rite	Alignment: Pagan	Any	A discovered ritual site here (owned or not)	Wild Hunt or Blood Offering	Wild Hunt: two of the province's beasts join as Veterans for the price of one, no wages, until the end of the following turn. Blood Offering: sacrifice units to raise an equal number of others +2 tiers.	Wild Hunt: one beast's price	0	One rite per province per turn (R-008). Only the Blood Offering at a humanoid province's stones.
Harvest the Field	Alignment: Undead	Any	Battlefield graves here	Here	Raise one grave (the most experienced dead) as a Skeletal unit, no magic needed.	2g	0	Give it to a Necromancy 1 character before turn's end.

Mastery orders (level 7 and 9 of a non-magic skill)

Order	Skill	Target	What the hero is told on unlocking it	What the orders form says
Challenge	Melee 7	character	Challenge: call out an enemy commander in your province to single combat.	Melee 7: call out a LONE enemy hero in your province to single combat — the loser is wounded, or slain.
Rampage	Melee 9	character	Rampage: after winning a duel, immediately strike a second enemy force.	Melee 9: hurl yourself at an enemy force in your province — cut down several of its units and wound its commander.
Rain of Arrows	Archery 7	character	Rain of Arrows: a free pre-battle volley that softens the enemy front line.	Archery 7: loose a volley on an enemy force in your province, felling several of its units.
Sniper's Mark	Archery 9	character	Sniper's Mark: target an enemy commander before battle for a chance to wound or slay them.	Archery 9: mark an enemy commander in your province — a telling shot that wounds, and may slay.
Feigned Retreat	Tactical 7	none	Feigned Retreat: bait an attacker, then counter at +strength.	Tactical 7: bait your attacker — if you are attacked this turn, your defence counters at +25% strength.
Grand Stratagem	Tactical 9	none	Grand Stratagem: dictate the terms of one battle.	Tactical 9: dictate the terms of battle — your next battle this turn is fought at +20% strength.
Forced March	March 7	province (move_adjacent)	Forced March: march to an adjacent province with a 50% chance to slip past a battle this phase (once per turn).	March 7: march to an adjacent province — if an enemy army or a Defend order awaits, a 50% chance to slip in without a battle this phase (the fight comes next phase if you stay, or at turn end).
Lightning Advance	March 9	none	Lightning Advance: a foe you attack this turn fights with no terrain bonus, no pre-battle magic and no pre-battle archery.	March 9: strike before they can set — enemies you attack this turn lose their defensive footing (−20%).
Blockade	Naval 7	province (sea_adjacent)	Blockade (needs a fleet): a 50% chance to seal a sea province so enemies may not cross it this turn.	Naval 7: seal a sea province you are in or adjacent to — enemy fleets may not cross it this turn.

Order	Skill	Target	What the hero is told on unlocking it	What the orders form says
Raid the Coast	Naval 9	none	Raid the Coast (needs a fleet): an amphibious assault launched from the sea at +strength, plundering the province treasury if you capture it.	Naval 9: an amphibious assault — when you come ashore from the sea this turn and fight for the coast you land on, you hit at +25% strength (the whole landing does, even if another hero takes command of it).
Research Breakthrough	Sage 7	none	Research Breakthrough: a guaranteed Sage discovery this turn.	Sage 7: a guaranteed scholarly discovery this turn (if any remain undiscovered by your realm).
Grand Design	Sage 9	none	Grand Design: realise your alignment's unique realm-wide Wonder.	Sage 9: complete your realm’s Grand Design — a unique, once-ever Wonder whose blessing is set by your realm’s alignment.
Grand Design	Sage 9	none	Grand Design: realise your alignment's unique realm-wide Wonder.	Realise your alignment's Wonder; see the Mastery sheet.
Sabotage	Spy 7	province (enemy)	Sabotage: wreck an enemy province (−tax / disband a garrison unit next turn).	Spy 7: wreck an enemy province you can see — it yields no tax next turn and loses a garrison unit.
Assassinate	Spy 9	character	Assassinate: attempt to kill an enemy hero in a province you have infiltrated.	Spy 9: attempt to slay an enemy hero in the province you stand in — a spy-level chance to kill.
Grand Heist	Thief 7	here	Grand Heist: once per turn, crack the vaults of the enemy capital or rich province you stand in — a quarter of that realm's treasury and a magic item off one of their couriers.	Thief 7 · ONE attempt per thief per turn (spent win or lose). You crack the vaults of THE PROVINCE YOU STAND IN — no hero is targeted. Where: the province must be held by a realm you are AT WAR with, and be their HOME CAPITAL or RICH country (tax 7+). Take: 25% of that realm's treasury (doubled at Thief 8, even past what they can cover) AND one magic item — cut from a courier still on the road inside their realm, from a Send Item order made earlier this turn (a heist never touches what a hero carries in their own pack — that is the Steal order). Odds: 60% +5% per Thief level past 5, halved if the vaults are guarded (a garrison stands there, or an enemy commander of that realm is present with troops). Fail and you are seen unless you slip away (Thief × 20%) — then a hero of that realm draws steel on you (lead with Flee in your Encounter Plan if you would rather not fight), or if none is there the guards beat you off.
Vanish	Thief 9	none	Vanish: nothing can bring you to bay this turn — no pursuit, Encounter or ambush.	Thief 9: melt into the shadows — for the rest of this turn no pursuit, Encounter or ambush can bring you to bay, and no thief caught in the act can be cornered.
Awaken Grove	Druid 7	none	Awaken Grove: raise a temporary Creature host from a forest or jungle you hold.	Druid 7: while in an owned forest, jungle or wild (Creature or Monster) province, raise a temporary Creature host that fights until turn’s end.
Wild Calling	Druid 9	none	Wild Calling: turn a whole wild (Creature or Monster) province's defenders to your side.	Druid 9: while standing in a wild (Creature or Monster) province, call its wild host to your banner — several of its beasts defect to you.
Chart the Unknown	Explorer 7	here_or_adjacent	Chart the Unknown: fully explore this province and reveal all its neighbours.	Explorer 7: fully chart the province you stand in OR one bordering it — 100% mapped, every lair in it revealed, and all ITS neighbours glimpsed at 25%.
Discover Lost Ruin	Explorer 9	lair_tier	Discover Lost Ruin: guaranteed to find and reveal a hidden lair or treasure site.	Explorer 9: name a class of lair. EVERY lair of that class in your province and in each bordering province is laid bare at once. A rival's Hide Lairs glamour still conceals what it covers.

What each action costs in movement points

What you do	Points
Move one province (any terrain)	1
Sail into the sea, or land on a coast	1 sea
March into empty unclaimed land, or an undefended enemy province (and take it)	1
Attack and win	2 (1 to step in, 1 for the victory)
Attack and lose	1
Press on with an unfinished battle next phase	1 if you have one (fought anyway if not)
Defend: ride out to a neighbour	1

What you do	Points
Encounter: each step of a chase	1
Search a lair, fight its guardian, Explore, retreat after a loss	0

A character leading no army has a flat 5 land and 5 sea points. A column moves at its slowest unit's pace plus the leader's March (land) or Naval (sea): +0/+1/+1/+2/+3 at levels 1–5.

The order of events inside a phase

When	What happens
Start of phase	Defend orders for this phase take effect; every army about to march into a watched province is spotted. Nobody moves.
Non-moving orders	Casting, transfers, items, recruiting, hiring, practice, research, rest, spying and the rest resolve in initiative order (sum of all skills, March ×3) with everyone where the phase began.
The Defend step	Generals on watch ride out: first to the strongest marching threat (or hold their own gate), failing that to a host raised inside the watch.
Moves and Encounters	Columns arrive, battles are fought, chases close.
After all orders	A last sweep for enemy hosts inside a watch; lone characters on Defend spring ambushes.
End of turn	Tax and wages settle together; graves decay; garrisons drill; couriers arrive; charms fade; Elven survivors come home.

Gaps, questions and things to check

These are observations from reading the data files, the engine and the rulebook together. None of them is a ruling. Each is a question for Toby or a place where two sources disagree.

#	Observation
1	Druidic and Evil realms have no signature order; every other creed has one. See the Alignments sheet.
2	Mastery order hints and unlock texts differ in several figures (listed on the Mastery sheet).
3	Hunting Rumours and Explore both cost a phase and spend no movement; Rest competes with them. A hero in a quiet province has three "free" orders and no way to do two at once.
4	Hire Hero lets you pre-write the hero's orders; Charm and Resurrect do too (R-014). Broker hires at a distance but the rulebook does not say whether pre-written orders apply there.
5	Steal halves against a commander leading troops; Encounter's slip-past roll loses 8% per unit led. The two "guarded" penalties use different shapes.
6	Sabotage, Assassinate and Grand Heist are limited to realms you are at war with; the rulebook says only "some mastery abilities". The list should be stated once.
7	The orders form knows 46 actions; a new player sees far fewer because alignment, king-only and mastery orders are filtered. Worth a line in the rulebook saying the list grows.